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A SMALL BUSINESS PLAYBOOK

Scrubs & Scripture

A companion guide for turning a quiet calling into a lasting ministry, with the gentle scaffolding of a real business beneath it.

PREPARED FOR

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Scrubs & Scripture

A practical plan forward.

WHAT THIS IS

Not a traditional consult. *A pathway to what's next.*

Most small-business consulting leaves you with a 40-page PDF, a generic financial model, and the same question you started with: *now what?*

This is a different kind of document. It's a playbook, built specifically for you — for your city, your license, your voice, and the decisions actually in front of you right now. It names the rules that apply, the people worth calling, the grants worth your Saturday, and the traps worth avoiding. Everything in it has been researched for your specific context, not pulled from a template.

Keep it. Print it. Mark it up with a pen. Bring it to your CPA. Come back to it in year two when the business has pivoted and you need to remember what you were building toward. It's meant to walk with you — not sit in a drawer.

— **BayouBuilt Digital**, *a service of D&G Fuzion LLC · Acadiana, Louisiana*

A note before we begin

This guide is meant to be educational and organizational — a warm hand pointing at what matters — **not legal, tax, financial, or clinical advice, and not a substitute for consultation with a licensed professional in any of those fields.**

The information here reflects what's publicly available as of April 2026 and reflects general research, not case-specific guidance. Tax code, municipal ordinances, professional licensing rules, and regulatory interpretations change frequently.

Three decisions in particular are worth walking through with a professional: your business structure, the IRS hobby-vs-business question, and anything that touches clinical or healthcare topics given your LPN license. When those come up, a call to the Louisiana State Board of Practical Nurse Examiners (for scope questions), a licensed Louisiana attorney (for structure and liability questions), or a CPA (for tax questions) is time well spent.

Neither BayouBuilt Digital nor D&G Fuzion LLC provides legal, tax, accounting, or clinical advice, and nothing in this document should be acted on without independent verification from an appropriate licensed professional.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Everything, *in order.*

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PART ONE

The Business *Foundation*

What you want this to be, how the IRS sees a blog, what it costs to set up legitimately in Covington, and what actually qualifies as a write-off.

§ 1

Before You *Decide Anything*

Everything in this guide — the structure, the money, the content — flows from a decision you haven't made yet. What do you actually want this to be?

Most guides skip straight to "here's how to file your LLC." That's backwards. A business structure you'll never use is just paperwork. A content plan aimed at the wrong audience is just noise. The first job is to get clear on what you're building and who you're building it for — in words you can actually say out loud.

This section is the quiet work. It's meant to be done with a pen and coffee, not at a computer. Read the prompts. Let them sit. Answer in your own voice, not a polished one.

Language first — what these words actually mean

Before anything else, here's the vocabulary. You don't need to use these words out loud, but understanding what they mean makes every other decision easier.

Mission

Why you exist. The thing that stays the same whether you have 10 readers or 10,000. It's usually one sentence, written in your own words, that captures why this work is worth doing. Good mission statements are specific enough that you could test any future decision against them.

Audience

Who you're writing to. Not "everyone." The single, specific person you picture when you write. The more specific, the better everything gets.

Brand voice

How you sound. Warm or bold? Gentle or direct? Poetic or plainspoken? Your voice is the thing that makes a reader know it's you before they see your name.

Brand promise

What a reader gets from showing up. If she opens one of your emails, what does she walk away with? A feeling? A practical takeaway? A moment of recognition? The answer shapes everything you publish.

Positioning

What makes you different. There are blogs in every niche. What's different about yours — what specific angle, experience, or perspective do you bring that others in the space don't?

Scale

How big you want it. Not how big it *could* get — how big you *want* it. A 2,000-reader audience is a success. So is a 200,000-follower platform. They require completely different lives.

Five questions to answer before anything else

These aren't quiz questions. They're the ones that quietly decide whether you're still writing this blog three years from now. Write answers down — on paper if you can. Don't edit them.

QUESTION 01

"If one stranger read this blog and it changed something for her, what would I want that to be?"

This is your mission, unpolished. Not "build a platform." Not "earn income." The real thing. The thing worth showing up for. Start here because every other decision gets tested against this answer.

QUESTION 02

"Picture one real person I'd write this for. Who is she? What does her Tuesday night look like?"

Not a demographic. Not "Christian women 35–55." A specific woman. Maybe a new LPN who's questioning her calling. Maybe a 20-year nurse who hasn't prayed in weeks. Maybe a chaplain. When you can describe one real reader in detail, you'll never run out of things to write.

QUESTION 03

"What am I not willing to do, even if it would grow the blog faster?"

This one matters more than people think. Maybe you won't do gossip. Maybe you won't do flashy drama. Maybe you won't take ads from sketchy brands. Knowing your "no" up front protects you from a hundred small compromises later.

QUESTION 04

"What does 'success' look like — for me? Not for anyone else."

Is it $500/month of supplemental income while staying at the bedside? A full-time speaking/writing career five years out? A single book you're proud of? A small email list of nurses who genuinely know each other? All of those are real success — but the paths are different. Pick yours.

QUESTION 05

"If someone shared my blog with a friend in one sentence, what do I want them to say?"

That sentence — whatever you write — is your positioning. It's the shortest version of your brand. Most blogs never get one. When you have it, every piece of content gets easier to write, every design decision gets easier to make, every collaboration gets easier to vet.

DON'T SKIP THIS, EVEN IF IT FEELS SLOW

Everything in the next 13 sections assumes you have answers here — even rough ones. Go back to this page every few months and rewrite the answers. They'll sharpen. That sharpening *is* your brand forming.

Four voices — which one is yours?

Most faith-content creators fall into one of four natural voices. None is better than the others. But knowing which is yours shortcuts a hundred decisions — what to write, how to write it, even what colors and fonts feel right on your site.

Read all four. One will feel like it fits like a glove. Another will feel close-but-not-quite. Two will feel wrong. That's the point.

The Encourager

WARMTH · COMFORT · PRESENCE

Writes like a wise friend. Soft, affirming, pastoral. Her reader leaves feeling seen and a little less alone. Strong on reflection, devotion, and emotional honesty. Light on tactics or sharp opinions.

> *"Friend, I know what this shift cost you. Put your bag down. Let's breathe together."*

Best fit: reflections, devotionals, grief writing, membership communities
Income paths that match: devotionals, digital journals, speaking to women's groups, retreat leadership

The Teacher

CLARITY · STRUCTURE · WISDOM

Writes like a trusted mentor. Clear, organized, scripture-grounded. Her reader leaves with something concrete — a framework, a verse to memorize, a practice to try. Strong on Bible study, practical theology, craft.

> *"Here's what I've noticed about rest in Scripture — and three ways I practice it on a 12-hour shift."*

Best fit: Bible studies, how-to writing, teaching resources, faith formation content
Income paths that match: study guides, courses, curriculum for small groups, teaching at conferences

The Storyteller

WITNESS · NARRATIVE · TESTIMONY

Writes like a careful chronicler. Her writing lives in scenes — a moment, a patient's family, a hallway conversation. The theology arrives through the story, not in spite of it. Strong on memoir, essay, literary nonfiction.

> *"The chaplain came in at 3 a.m. He didn't say anything at first. He just sat with her."*

Best fit: essays, memoir, long-form personal writing, podcasts
Income paths that match: book deal, literary magazine essays, podcast sponsorships, paid Substack

The Advocate

CONVICTION · DIRECTION · VOICE

Writes like someone who won't be quiet about what matters. Strong opinions, clear calls to action, a sense of mission beyond the page. Her reader leaves activated — to pray, to speak up, to change something.

> *"The Church has left its healthcare workers behind. I want to talk about why — and what we do about it."*

Best fit: opinion pieces, advocacy writing, leadership content, conference keynotes
Income paths that match: speaking tours, nonprofit partnerships, book deals, coaching, paid community leadership

ON MIXING VOICES

Most successful faith writers lead with one voice and borrow 10–20% from one other. Your current three posts read like an Encourager with Teacher tendencies — warm, personal, but with clear structure ("The Meaning Behind the Scrubs," "Understanding the Importance…"). Lean into Encourager as the primary voice, let Teacher show up when the topic calls for it, and a distinctive brand will emerge naturally.

The scale question — how big do you want this?

This is the question almost no one asks themselves honestly at the start. Bigger isn't better. Bigger is just *different*. Each scale requires a different life.

THE SCALE SPECTRUM

Where do you honestly want to land? There's no wrong answer — but the answer shapes everything else.

Ministry — **Platform**

Ministry end: 200–2,000 loyal readers, $0–500/mo, stays part-time, feels like a calling you tend. Platform end: 50,000+ followers, $50K+/year, becomes (or replaces) a full-time job, requires a team eventually.

SCALE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT DEMANDS
Ministry	200–2,000 readers. Modest email list. Occasional speaking at local churches. A small printed devotional sold at events. $0–500/mo.	A few hours a week. No team needed. Can coexist indefinitely with full-time nursing.
Side platform	5,000–15,000 readers. Regular speaking. One or two digital products. Affiliate income. $500–3,000/mo.	10–15 hrs/week. Maybe a VA or editor. Still coexists with nursing — but gets tight.
Full platform	50,000+ followers. Book deal. Retreats. Courses. Consistent sponsor relationships. $50K–150K+/year.	Full-time work. A team: VA, editor, designer, possibly manager. Eventually replaces nursing income.

HONEST FRAMING

"Ministry" is not a consolation prize. Some of the most respected voices in Christian healthcare writing have audiences under 5,000 — and they reach the right people, deeply, for decades. The "platform" path is also real and valuable, but it's a different job than nursing and should be chosen on purpose, not drifted into. Pick the scale that matches the life you actually want.

Naming & visual identity — the lightweight version

"Scrubs & Scripture" already passes the most important test: it's memorable, specific, and tells you exactly what you're getting. The name is working. What's worth refining from here is everything around it.

SIX QUESTIONS FOR THE VISUAL IDENTITY

1. **Colors:** Soft and warm (cream, rose, sage, gold)? Or clean and minimal (white, navy, one accent)? Your current palette leans warm — that fits the Encourager voice.
2. **Fonts:** A classic serif (like an old prayer book) or something more modern? The serif route fits faith content beautifully and rarely goes out of style.
3. **Photography style:** Natural light, hands, candles, open Bibles? Or portraits, clinical settings, scrubs? Choose one and commit — consistency is 80% of branding.
4. **Logo:** A simple wordmark is usually enough at this stage. A real logo treatment can wait until there's income to justify the $300–800 a designer charges.
5. **Tagline:** "Bridging Compassionate Care with Eternal Truth" is fine. "Scripture for the shift" might be tighter and more memorable. Worth testing once.
6. **Instagram handle / social:** Match the domain where possible — *@scrubsandscripture* is the target. Lock it everywhere, even if not using it yet.

A RULE THAT SAVES A LOT OF MONEY

Do not pay for a logo, a photography session, or a "brand refresh" in the first six months. You don't know yet who you're writing for. Everything you design now will feel wrong in six months — and that's fine, because the real branding happens through your writing, not your logo.

A NOTE FROM YOUR CORNER

You weren't meant to figure *all of this* out alone.

If you've read this far and felt the edges of overwhelm creeping in — good. That means you're taking it seriously. It also means this is exactly where most dreams quietly stall. Not because the dreamer wasn't capable. Because nobody should have to translate IRS code, Louisiana parish forms, brand strategy, and nursing-board rules on her own while also working shifts and raising a life.

That's why we exist.

BayouBuilt Digital sits inside D&G Fuzion LLC — a family-built studio in Louisiana that walks alongside women who have something worth saying and need a thoughtful hand to help them build the thing that lets them say it.

- → A conversation about what you actually want this to look like
- → Help making the right filings in the right order, without the guesswork
- → A website that reads like you — not like a template
- → Steady support as the blog grows, so you're never stuck at the next step

No pressure. No packages you don't need. Just a quiet invitation to not do the hard parts by yourself.

START A CONVERSATION

— **BayouBuilt Digital**, *a service of D&G Fuzion LLC*

§ 2 — THE REFRAME

A Blog *is not* a Business.

These two words get used like they mean the same thing. They don't. And understanding the difference changes every other decision in this guide.

BLOG

A *publishing format.*

Words on a webpage. Anyone can start one. You can run one for twenty years and never earn a dollar — that's fine. It's still a blog.

BUSINESS

An *activity for profit.*

Income, expenses, records, a plan. It can use a blog as its delivery mechanism. But the blog is never the business.

The business is the thing you build around the blog — not the blog itself.

ASPECT	BLOG (BY ITSELF)	BUSINESS (THAT PUBLISHES A BLOG)
Purpose	Self-expression, ministry, journaling, sharing	Serving an audience with intent to earn income
Legal status	None required	DBA or LLC, EIN, occupational license, bank account
Tax treatment	No write-offs. Any income is hobby income (taxed, not deductible against).	Schedule C. Expenses deductible against income.
Income streams	None — or incidental (one-off affiliate click)	Intentional: email list → products → ads → services → book
What it costs	$200/year (domain + Wix)	$200/year + $100–300 setup + ongoing CPA & bookkeeping time
Time horizon	Post when inspired	Weekly rhythm, multi-year plan, measurable growth

> **RIGHT NOW, SCRUBS & SCRIPTURE IS A BLOG**
>
> Three posts, a beautiful design, a real voice, a clear mission. That's a blog — and it's a lovely one. The work ahead is turning it *into* a business: adding the legal structure from Part I, the monetization ladder from Part II, and the consistent publishing rhythm that makes both of those worth having.

The blog income reality — before anyone builds a plan on fantasy math

There's a stubborn myth that "once I have a blog, the ad money will roll in." The real numbers are much smaller than most people expect. Blog ad income is measured in **RPM** — revenue per 1,000 page views. Here's what that actually looks like:

AD NETWORK	TYPICAL RPM	TRAFFIC MINIMUM	$/MO AT 10K VIEWS
Google AdSense	$2–5	None	~$20–50

AD NETWORK	TYPICAL RPM	TRAFFIC MINIMUM	$/MO AT 10K VIEWS
Ezoic	$5–15	None (was 10K, now removed)	~$50–150
Mediavine Journey	$10–20	10K monthly sessions	~$100–200
Raptive (AdThrive)	$20–40	100K monthly page views	Not eligible at 10K
Mediavine	$15–35	50K monthly sessions	Not eligible at 10K

> **THE MATH NOBODY PUTS IN THE SALES PITCH**
>
> Faith-niche blogs sit on the *lower* end of most RPM ranges because advertisers pay more for commercial-intent niches (finance, insurance, legal) than inspirational ones. A faith/healthcare blog hitting 10,000 monthly page views might realistically earn **$30–80/month from ads**. Hitting 50,000 monthly views — which takes most bloggers 1–3 years of consistent posting — might earn **$400–800/month**. The truly meaningful money in this niche is not ads. It's products, speaking, and partnerships.

Where blog income actually comes from, ranked by $/hour for faith bloggers

1. **Speaking engagements** — $500–5,000 per event. One retreat pays more than six months of ads.
2. **Book deal + backlist** — long game, but a single successful book can exceed five years of ad revenue.
3. **Digital products** — devotionals, studies, journals. A $19 product sold 100 times/month is $1,900 — no traffic minimums, no ad network gatekeepers.
4. **Sponsored content / brand partnerships** — $200–2,000 per post once engagement is real, not just follower count.
5. **Coaching / community / membership** — recurring revenue from a small, loyal audience.
6. **Affiliate income** — meaningful once traffic is established, but slow.
7. **Display ads** — the most passive, but also the smallest slice for a faith-niche blog. Do it, but don't count on it.

THE MENTAL SHIFT

The blog is not the income. The blog is the *trust-building machine* that makes every other income stream possible. Readers who love your writing become email subscribers, who become product buyers, who become retreat attendees, who eventually become book readers. Each rung of that ladder pays more than the last. Ad revenue is a pleasant side effect, not the plan.

§ 3

The Honest *Niche Reality*

Before we build a business plan around any specific idea, a careful look at the commercial landscape. This is the conversation most guides skip — and it's the conversation that determines whether the next five years are rewarding or exhausting.

Where faith + healthcare content sits, commercially

The niche Scrubs & Scripture currently sits in — **faith-based healthcare reflection** — is emotionally powerful and absolutely worth writing in. But it's one of the harder spaces to monetize, and anyone thinking about this as a business needs to see why clearly before building around it.

THE HEADWINDS

Why this niche is tough commercially

Faith content is a low-CPM ad category — advertisers pay less for inspirational audiences than for commercial-intent ones (finance, health products, legal). The audience is often loyal but small. Direct revenue (ads, affiliate) is slow to compound. Most successful creators in this space took 3–5 years to reach meaningful income.

THE TAILWINDS

What does work in this niche

High audience trust once established. Products sell well (devotionals, journals, studies) because buyers are loyal. Speaking pays well when a real platform exists. Book deals are achievable. But every one of these requires an audience first — which takes years.

THE DIRECT VERSION

If the goal is **income within 12–24 months**, faith + healthcare writing alone is unlikely to get there. If the goal is **a long-term ministry that eventually pays**, it can absolutely work — but the timeline needs to be honest. Most people confuse these two goals at the start and end up discouraged in year two when the income hasn't arrived on the schedule they imagined.

A note about AI idea-generation tools

⚠ IMPORTANT — READ BEFORE USING CHATGPT / AI FOR BUSINESS IDEAS

AI tools are designed to keep you engaged, not to tell you the truth.

If you've asked ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or any AI chatbot to help brainstorm business ideas, you've probably noticed it gets enthusiastic about almost everything you suggest. That's not because your ideas are all brilliant. It's because **those systems are optimized for engagement** — continued conversation, good feeling, returning users. Honest skepticism hurts their metrics. So they default to encouragement.

This creates a real problem for someone starting out. The AI will happily help you plan a business that has no viable path to revenue, because disagreeing with you would end the conversation. It will generate content calendars, brand names, and launch plans for ideas that experienced humans would gently push back on.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

AI's typical response: "What a beautiful idea! A faith-based healthcare blog combined with an Etsy shop selling handmade scrubs would be amazing. Let me help you build a 90-day launch plan..."

What an experienced advisor might say instead: "That's two very different businesses that don't reinforce each other. Handmade scrubs is a physical product business with manufacturing overhead. A faith blog is a content business. Doing both at once usually means doing neither well. Which one is the actual calling?"

How to use AI tools without getting led astray:

→ Ask it to **argue against** your idea, not for it. Prompt: *"Give me the five strongest reasons this business would fail."*

- → Ask for **base rates**, not inspiration. Prompt: *"What percentage of blogs in this niche reach $1,000/month, and how long does it typically take?"*
- → Ask it to **name specific competitors** and tell you why they succeeded or failed. Vague encouragement is useless; specific examples are gold.
- → Never let it write the plan alone. Use it for research and brainstorming. Let a real human — a mentor, an SBDC advisor, a local business owner — stress-test the plan.
- → If an AI's answer feels like a pep rally, **the pep rally is the product**. Close the tab and talk to someone who has actually built what you're trying to build.

The same goes for this document, honestly. Everything in here reflects our best analysis — but it's *analysis*, not prophecy. An hour with LSBDC-Southeastern (the regional Small Business Development Center that now holds sessions at the St. Tammany EDC office right here in Covington) or SCORE New Orleans (both free) is worth more than a hundred AI chats, because they will tell you the truth — including the truth you'd rather not hear. See §18 for full contact details.

Paths worth exploring — if commercial viability matters

If a 3–5 year runway is fine, keep writing Scrubs & Scripture as-is and layer in the monetization steps later in this guide. But if income on a faster timeline is part of the picture, here are directions that tend to convert faster for women in healthcare with writing talent. Each one is an actual path, not a dream, with real-world examples to study.

1. The clinical-to-commercial writer

FASTEST TO REVENUE

Freelance writing for healthcare brands, medical device companies, and health-tech startups. Nurses with the ability to write clearly are genuinely in demand because most agency writers don't understand clinical workflow. Rates typically range from $0.25–$1.00/word, scaling fast with portfolio.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

Nurse Keith (nursekeith.com) built a career around nurse career coaching + speaking. Search "RN freelance writer healthcare content" for active practitioners. Platforms: Contently, nDash, direct outreach to companies like Mighty Health, Carbon Health, Ro.

Revenue reality: $500–3,000/month within 3–6 months is realistic for a strong writer. Scales to $5,000–10,000/month within 18 months if pursued seriously.

2. The nurse educator / coach

HIGH RATE PER HOUR

NCLEX tutoring, LPN-to-RN transition coaching, nursing school application help, burnout coaching for working nurses. A tight niche with clear buyers. Hourly rates $50–150 starting out, scaling with specialization.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

Simple Nursing (huge YouTube + course business), NRSNG / NursingSchoolWeek, Picmonic. Smaller operators: search "nurse coach" on Instagram to see dozens of sole-practitioner coaches running real businesses.

Revenue reality: First paying clients usually within 1–3 months. $1,000–5,000/month within a year if marketing is consistent.

3. The product-led maker

SCALES WITHOUT TRADING TIME

Digital products specifically for nurses: study guides, clinical reference cards, nursing journal templates, shift-planner printables, NCLEX flashcards. Sold on Etsy, Teachers Pay Teachers (yes, nurses buy there too), or a personal shop. Low overhead, high margin, works while you sleep.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

Search "nursing printable" on Etsy — many shops have thousands of sales. Nursing School Resources, AllNurses shops, and many Instagram-driven solo sellers.

Revenue reality: $100–500/month within 3–6 months. $1,000–5,000/month achievable in year two with catalog depth (30+ products) and decent SEO.

4. The specialized health-content authority

LONG GAME, BIG CEILING

Pick one narrow clinical topic — diabetes education, postpartum care, elder caregiving, chronic pain — and build the go-to English-language resource for patients and families. Narrower than faith + healthcare generally, but far more searchable, more ad-friendly (health niche = higher RPM), and more monetizable through affiliate products.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

Diabetes Strong (full-time income), At A Glance Caregiving, Postpartum Progress (though now quiet). Search "nurse-run health niche blog" for more.

Revenue reality: Slower start (6–12 months to first dollar) but higher ceiling. $3,000–15,000/month within 2–3 years is realistic with consistent publishing and SEO focus.

5. The local services operator

HIGHEST MARGIN, HANDS-ON

Private-duty companion care, respite services for family caregivers, CPR/first-aid instruction, basic health-literacy education, community workshops, light home-health-aide coordination. The least glamorous option — and often the most profitable. Covington's demographics (aging population, above-average income) make this viable locally. **Important:** clinical services requiring nursing judgment (IV therapy, wound care, clinical assessment, medication administration) require either employment through a licensed home-health agency or a collaborating-physician agreement. Solo operation means staying on the non-clinical side or working as a contractor under someone else's clinical oversight.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

Local CPR instructors on AHA Instructor Network, companion-care agencies like Home Instead and Visiting Angels (study their service menus to see what fits within non-clinical scope), Louisiana-licensed home-health operators for the clinical-contractor lane.

Revenue reality: First non-clinical client within weeks. $2,000–6,000/month within 6 months for a companion/education service. Clinical work via agency contract: agency pays $25–40/visit, scales by volume. **Scope check required before launch** — call LSBPNE to confirm any service structure in writing.

6. The hybrid — writing + services

HOW MOST REAL BUSINESSES WORK

Almost every profitable nurse-creator runs two things: a content platform that builds trust, and one paid service/product that converts trust to revenue. The blog or Instagram is the top of the funnel; the 1:1 coaching, the course, or the freelance writing contract is where the money actually comes from. Scrubs & Scripture could become the trust-building platform with one of the paths above as the revenue engine.

REAL EXAMPLES TO STUDY

The Nurse CEO (content + coaching), Nurse Money Talk (content + products), Nurse Fern (content + courses). Study their email signups and product pages — that's where the business actually lives.

Revenue reality: This is the model that compounds. Slower than pure services but higher ceiling than pure content. Most creators doing $100K+/year run this hybrid.

A QUESTION WORTH SITTING WITH

Is Scrubs & Scripture a **calling** that happens to generate income as a byproduct — or is it meant to be the **primary income vehicle**? Both are valid. But they lead to different business structures, different timelines, and very different decisions. If it's the first, the existing plan in this guide works beautifully as-is. If it's the second, pairing it with one of the revenue paths above is worth considering — before the next year of effort goes into something that may take five years to pay.

§ 4

Finding *Market Gaps* — And Moving Fast

If getting profitable sooner rather than later matters, the question stops being "what do I want to build?" and starts being "where is there an unmet need that I'm uniquely positioned to serve?" This section teaches the skill, then shows you specific gaps in your own backyard.

WHY THIS MATTERS RIGHT NOW

A business built on a *gap* — a real need with few competitors — pays faster than a business built on a *passion* that fights for attention in a crowded space. You don't have to abandon the passion. You just pair it with something that pays the bills while the passion project matures. The nurses earning six figures online nearly all did this: they found a gap, served it, then built the platform around the revenue. Not the other way around.

Part A — How to find a gap yourself

This is a skill, not a lucky guess. Five methods, in rough order of speed. Use all of them — each one reveals different opportunities.

METHOD 01

Listen to complaints in your own community

Gaps live inside the sentence "I can't believe nobody..." or "Why isn't there a..." Every time you hear one — at work, at church, in the school pickup line, in a Facebook group — write it down. Two weeks of listening will surface five to ten real opportunities.

> **How to do it this week:** Start a note in your phone titled "Gaps." Every complaint you hear from a nurse, a patient's family, a neighbor, or a Facebook post — write the exact words. Look for patterns. A complaint repeated by three different people is a business idea.

METHOD 02

Search the way your customer searches

Google autocomplete, Reddit, and YouTube comments reveal what people are actively trying to solve. If the top results are weak, thin, or missing — that's a gap. If there are thousands of questions with no good answers, that's a gap with a line forming.

> **How to do it this week:** Type half a question into Google and look at the autocomplete suggestions — those are real searches people make. Examples to try:
>
> `LPN how to quit nursing` `home health care Covington reviews`
> `companion care near me` `caregiver support group St Tammany`
> `NCLEX tutor near me`
>
> Then go to r/nursing and sort by top posts of the month. The recurring complaints *are* the market.

METHOD 03

Read the one-star and three-star reviews

Five-star reviews are marketing. One-star reviews are complaints (often unreasonable). **Three-star reviews are gold** — people who mostly liked something but had a real unmet expectation. That expectation is the gap.

> **How to do it this week:** Search Google Maps for "home health" / "private duty nursing" / "CPR class" / "elder care" in Covington, Mandeville, and Slidell. Read the three-star reviews on the top three companies in each category. The complaints will be strikingly consistent. Now you know what an underserved customer actually wants.

METHOD 04

Find the "duct-tape solution"

When people are solving a problem with a clunky workaround — a group chat, a shared Google Doc, a hand-written binder — there's a business in turning the workaround into a product or service. Workarounds mean the real solution doesn't exist yet at the right price.

> **How to do it this week:** Ask three nurses you know: "What's the most annoying thing you do every week that you wish someone had already solved?" Ask three family caregivers the same question. The answers are workarounds — and each one is a business someone will eventually build.

METHOD 05

Look where demographics are shifting

Demographic changes create reliable gaps. Aging population creates caregiver-support gaps. New subdivisions create local-service gaps. A region gaining young families creates postpartum and pediatric gaps. Demographics don't lie and change slowly — which means the gaps they create stay open long enough to build around.

> **How to do it this week:** Look at Census data for Covington and St. Tammany Parish. Note two things: the median age (higher than state average means aging-care demand) and the population growth rate (positive growth means new residents with service needs that existing providers haven't caught up to).

Part B — Specific gaps worth exploring in Covington right now

Covington and the broader Northshore have a combination that makes them unusually good for service-business launches: above-state-median household income, rapid population growth, an aging demographic, and a service-provider ecosystem that hasn't kept pace. Here are four gaps worth a weekend of research each.

For each one: the gap, why it's open, how to validate it this week, and what the revenue path looks like.

> **READ THIS BEFORE YOU GO FURTHER — LPN SCOPE FRAMES EVERYTHING BELOW**
>
> Every clinical service idea in this section — **every one of them** — requires you to operate under the direction of a physician, nurse practitioner, or registered nurse, per Louisiana RS 37:961. LPNs in Louisiana cannot independently assess patients, diagnose, or deliver clinical services without that direction. This is not a paperwork formality — it is the actual scope of your license, and operating outside it puts your license at risk regardless of how well the service is delivered.
>
> **What this means practically for the ideas below:** services that can be structured as *companion/sitter*, *education*, *coaching*, or *non-clinical navigation* are reachable solo. Services that involve clinical judgment (medication decisions, wound assessment, IV therapy, clinical monitoring) require either (a) a collaborating physician agreement on file, (b) employment under an RN or MD's direct supervision, or (c) working through a licensed home-health agency that carries the clinical responsibility. **Before launching any clinical service, call LSBPNE at (225) 755-7500** and describe the exact service you're planning. They will tell you what's permissible and what isn't. This conversation is free, and it is the single most important phone call you can make before committing.

1. Private-duty companion / sitter services (non-clinical lane)

MOST ACCESSIBLE SOLO PATH

Families of older adults in Covington repeatedly report difficulty finding a trustworthy companion or sitter for short shifts (3–8 hours) — respite for family caregivers, overnight companionship, transport to appointments, meal prep, safety supervision, light household support. Large home-health agencies require 4-hour minimums and carry high overhead rates. A direct-to-family companion service operating clearly as **non-clinical support** — no medication administration, no wound care, no assessments — fills this gap and keeps you cleanly within LPN scope even when operating solo.

VALIDATE THIS WEEK

1. Call three Covington home-health agencies. Ask their hourly rate and minimum shift length for companion services vs. skilled nursing.
2. Post anonymously in the "St. Tammany Parish" Facebook group: "Does anyone have a recommendation for a companion/sitter for short shifts with an elderly parent?" Count the responses.
3. Call LSBPNE at (225) 755-7500 and ask: "What clinical activities must I avoid if operating as a private-duty companion without a supervising physician?" Document their answer in writing.

Revenue path: Companion rates $22–35/hour direct-pay. 15–20 hours/week = $1,400–2,800/month, often within 2–3 months. **If you want to add clinical services** (medication reminders vs. administration, wound observation vs. wound care, etc.) you'll need to either contract with a home-health agency that carries clinical responsibility, or establish a collaborating-physician relationship. Start companion-only, grow into clinical services later through proper structure.

2. Caregiver support & education for adult children of aging parents

GROWING DEMOGRAPHIC GAP

St. Tammany's aging population creates a shadow population: adult children (often women 45–65) suddenly responsible for a parent's medications, appointments, and home safety, with no clinical training. They're drowning. Existing resources are either too clinical (hospital hand-outs) or too corporate (Area Agency on Aging). A warm, plain-language "caregiver navigator" service — consultations, curated printables, short videos, group meetings — fills a real gap.

VALIDATE THIS WEEK

1. Post in 2–3 local Facebook groups: "Taking care of an aging parent? What's the one thing you wish someone had taught you?" Screenshot every answer.
2. Attend one meeting of an Alzheimer's Association support group in the area (they're open to the public). Listen for complaints.
3. Google "caregiver resources Covington LA" and see what exists. Note the gaps.

Revenue path: 1:1 caregiver consultations $75–150/hour. Small-group monthly classes $40–80/person, 8–12 attendees per session = $320–960/session. Digital guide bundle $29–49 sold online. This is the cleanest path to pairing with the existing faith/healthcare blog — the content writing becomes the top of the funnel for the service.

3. Post-hospital discharge navigation (as a contractor, not solo)

REAL GAP — REQUIRES PARTNERSHIP STRUCTURE

Patients discharged from hospitals are handed a folder of instructions and sent home. Within 30 days, a non-trivial percentage are readmitted — often for preventable reasons like medication confusion, missed follow-up appointments, or trouble understanding the discharge plan. Hospitals care because of Medicare readmission penalties. A service providing **non-clinical discharge navigation** — scheduling follow-up appointments, arranging transportation, translating the discharge folder into plain language, checking that the family understands what was sent home — is genuinely needed. Clinical activities (wound assessment, IV monitoring, physical assessment) require working through a licensed home-health agency that carries clinical responsibility, not operating solo.

VALIDATE THIS WEEK

1. Call LSBPNE first. Describe the non-clinical navigation model: "appointment scheduling, transportation coordination, helping families understand discharge paperwork, reminding about follow-ups — no clinical assessments." Get a clear answer on scope.
2. Call the case management or social work department at St. Tammany Health System and Ochsner — The Grove. Ask who they refer discharged patients to for in-home support and whether they'd consider a contracted navigator.
3. Call two local home-health agencies. Ask if they contract independent LPNs for clinical post-discharge visits and what their structure is.

Revenue path: Non-clinical navigation direct-pay from families: $125–175 per visit, 2–3 visits in the first week. 4–6 clients/month = $1,500–3,000/month. **Clinical lane (higher revenue):** contract with an established home-health agency as a per-visit LPN — they handle clinical responsibility, you handle the visits. This is the standard industry structure and the legally cleanest way to earn clinical-visit income as an LPN in Louisiana.

4. "New LPN" career coaching / onboarding support

LOWEST STARTUP COST

LPN programs graduate candidates who pass boards but arrive at their first nursing job anxious, under-trained on real workflow, and often quit within 90 days. Employers can't afford to hand-hold. Schools don't follow up. A 4–6 week paid coaching program for newly licensed LPNs (confidence building, shift survival, documentation best practices, handling difficult patients, self-care) fits a real gap that almost nobody is serving at this level — most career coaches target RNs.

VALIDATE THIS WEEK

1. Search Facebook for groups with "new LPN" or "LPN student" in the name. Read the most recent 50 posts. Count the anxious ones.
2. Check allnurses.com LPN forum for posts about "first week" or "quitting nursing." Identify the three most common struggles.
3. Look at what exists: search "new LPN coaching program" on Instagram and Google. If the top results are weak or nonexistent, that's your opening.

Revenue path: Packaged at $297–497 per 4-week cohort, delivered online (Zoom group calls + Slack or Circle community). 8–12 participants per cohort, running 6–8 cohorts/year = $14K–45K/year. Scales by adding cohorts or asynchronous course material. This is also the pivot that naturally feeds the blog — coaching grads become the audience.

HOW TO PICK ONE

Don't try to do all four. Pick the one where three things overlap: (1) you can talk to a real potential customer this week, (2) it matches your LSBPNE scope without a gray area, and (3) you can imagine yourself doing it for two years without getting tired of it. If one of the four passes all three tests — start there. If none do, the validation process itself will surface the right idea. The method is more durable than any specific opportunity.

How this pairs with Scrubs & Scripture

None of the paths above require shutting the blog down. In fact, the blog becomes *more valuable* once paired with a service — because every reader who trusts your voice through reflection becomes a potential caregiver-navigator client, or a referral source for discharge support, or a graduate of the new-LPN cohort. The blog is the trust. The service is the revenue. They reinforce each other in a way that pure content cannot.

The sequence most successful nurse-creators follow, honestly, is: **launch a service first → earn income → keep writing the blog alongside it → let the blog mature on its own timeline → eventually the blog becomes the top of the funnel for the service.** Reversed from how most guides tell you to do it, but it's how the real operators actually build.

BEFORE YOU PICK A PATH — ONE FREE HOUR THAT WILL CHANGE EVERYTHING

Before you commit to any of the paths above, make one phone call: the **Louisiana Small Business Development Center (LSBDC) satellite office at St. Tammany EDC**, right here in Covington. As of May 2025, LSBDC advisors from Southeastern Louisiana University hold free 1-on-1 counseling sessions at 1001 Hwy 190 East Service Rd, Suite 202 — ten minutes from most of Covington. Sessions are free, confidential, and conducted by advisors who have helped hundreds of Northshore entrepreneurs launch.

What to ask them: "I'm an LPN exploring a small business in Covington. Here are the three paths I'm weighing — which one fits best with what you see actually working in this market right now? And what local grants or LED programs apply to my situation?" An hour with them will sharpen your decision more than another week of research on your own. Book through louisianasbdc.org or by calling LSBDC-Southeastern at **(985) 549-3831**. See §18 for every local resource — SCORE, Chamber of Commerce, STartUP Northshore, all of them free, all of them in or near Covington.

§ 5

Beyond Nursing — *Where Your Thinking Actually Transfers*

Nursing training didn't just teach you clinical skills. It trained a way of thinking that's rare and valuable in industries that have nothing to do with healthcare. This section pulls those cognitive patterns out of the scrubs and shows you where else they're worth money.

The reframe that matters

Most career-pivot advice tells nurses to find something "nurse-adjacent" — a gentle lateral step that still looks like healthcare. That's a box, not a plan. The more interesting truth: **the mental habits nursing builds are underrepresented in most industries**, which means someone who genuinely has them — and can explain what they do — gets hired or hired-as-a-consultant faster than almost any other background.

Every pattern below is something you already do instinctively. The skill isn't acquiring them. The skill is **recognizing that you have them**, learning to describe them in the language of the industry you're targeting, and building a business around the one that fits you.

01 Triage thinking

Looking at chaos and instantly knowing what's urgent, what's important, and what can wait.

Nurses triage constantly — the new admit, the call bell, the family waiting, the med due, the doctor on the phone. That muscle is **exactly what operations roles and consulting work require**, and most non-nurses are surprisingly bad at it. They treat everything as equally urgent, or everything as equally negotiable. Someone who can walk into a disorganized office and say "this, this, then this" within an hour is rare and paid well.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **Small-business operations consulting** — coming into a 5–20 person business and organizing their workflow, priorities, and communication
>
> **Executive virtual assistant** for overwhelmed founders — the good ones run $40–80/hr and are chronically booked
>
> **Wedding or event coordination** — the actual job is triage under pressure with a smile, which nurses do in their sleep
>
> **Property management** for short-term rentals or multi-family buildings — a stream of simultaneous small crises

Earnings reality: Virtual assistant / ops roles $25–60/hour starting, $75–150/hour as a specialist. Event coordination $1,500–4,500 per event. Property management $50–200 per unit per month as a side line.

02 Hard-truth communication

Saying difficult things clearly and kindly, without softening them into lies.

Nurses tell people things they don't want to hear all day — *"I know you're in pain, and we can't give you another dose yet," "I'm sorry, your father isn't doing well," "This wound isn't healing the way we hoped."* You're trained to stay warm and honest at the same time. That combination is **rare** in any field where professionals have to deliver hard news — and most of them do it badly.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **Grief doula / end-of-life planning coach** — families hiring help to make the hard decisions
>
> **Money coaching / debt counseling** — telling people honestly what their situation is without shaming them
>
> **Family mediation** (certified in Louisiana) — stepping into conflict with neutrality and clarity
>
> **Real estate for elderly clients** or divorcing couples — deeply emotional transactions where most agents are awful at the human part
>
> **HR consulting** — delivering termination decisions, conducting investigations, facilitating hard conversations

Earnings reality: Grief doulas $75–150/hr. Certified Louisiana mediators $100–250/hr. HR consultants $85–200/hr. Real estate commissions vary, but an agent known for handling emotionally complex sales earns 2–3× average.

03 Teaching anxious adults complex things

Turning overwhelming information into something a scared person can actually use.

Every patient discharge is a teaching moment under time pressure, with someone whose fear is interfering with their comprehension. You translate complexity into plain language without condescension. That skill — **adult education for people who feel over their head** — is underpriced in almost every industry outside of healthcare. Most corporate trainers teach to people who aren't scared. That's the easy version.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **Financial literacy coaching** for adults (not children) — the market for first-time homebuyers, new widows, late-career career changers is huge
>
> **Tech onboarding / "digital literacy" for seniors** — teaching iPhone, banking apps, video calls without condescension
>
> **Course creator** — translating anything complex into a buyable digital course (legal basics, estate planning, insurance navigation)
>
> **Corporate training consultant** — workplace compliance, safety training, soft skills for teams
>
> **Driver's-ed / continuing-ed instructor** — anxious adult learners in structured settings

Earnings reality: Financial literacy coaches $60–125/session. Senior tech tutors $45–90/hour. Course creators highly variable — a $197 course selling 40/month = $7,800/month, and those numbers are realistic for a well-scoped, well-marketed niche course.

04 Systems, checklists, and protocol design

Building the boring infrastructure that prevents mistakes.

Nursing runs on SOPs, checklists, and documentation standards. You know instinctively that **a good checklist is worth a dozen trainings**. Most small businesses don't have this. Their onboarding is tribal knowledge. Their processes live in one person's head. A nurse who can walk into a chaotic small business and say "let me write down what you actually do" is doing exactly what hospitals call quality improvement — and those people are consultants earning real money.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **SOP / process consulting for small businesses** — writing down the "how we do things" manual for a 5–25 person company
>
> **Operations manual writing** for franchises, service businesses, nonprofits
>
> **Online-business backend systems** — setting up the Notion, Airtable, or workflow-automation infrastructure that solopreneurs don't know how to build
>
> **Church administration consulting** — small-to-mid churches desperately need someone who can write procedures and they have no budget

Earnings reality: SOP consulting $1,500–8,000 per engagement depending on scope. Operations manual writing $75–150/hour or flat $3,000–15,000 per manual. A strong niche in this space can run $60–120K/year solo.

05 Grace under pressure with strangers' vulnerability

Being unfazed by things that paralyze other professionals.

You've seen the worst day of people's lives and not flinched. You've helped strangers with their bodies, their shame, their grief, their fear. That calm is extraordinary and transferable. **Industries that involve high-stakes human moments pay a premium for someone who doesn't rattle** — because their staff either gets overwhelmed, gets too clinical, or gets too familiar.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **Funeral services** — family liaison, pre-need planning (Louisiana licensure required)
>
> **Victim advocacy / court advocacy** (paid and volunteer) — accompanying people through legal processes
>
> **Concierge travel for elderly or medically fragile travelers** — genuinely niche, genuinely high-fee
>
> **Forensic interviewing or legal support** (after additional training) — calm presence during depositions, interviews
>
> **Postpartum doula** or newborn care specialist — entry into a whole parallel profession

Earnings reality: Postpartum doulas $30–50/hour, specialists (newborn care) $35–75/hour often booked in 12-hour overnight shifts. Travel concierges $75–150/hour plus expenses. Victim advocacy often starts volunteer or grant-funded, builds to $45–80K/year salaried roles.

06 Documentation discipline

"If it isn't written down, it didn't happen" — built into your bones.

Nurses chart everything. That's not paperwork fussiness — it's risk management muscle memory. You instinctively know that clean, contemporaneous records protect everyone involved. **Most small businesses, solopreneurs, and even many mid-sized companies are disastrous at documentation.** They miss tax deductions, lose lawsuits, forget commitments, and re-learn lessons because nobody wrote it down. A nurse who brings that discipline into another context looks like a wizard.

> **WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE**
>
> **Bookkeeping** (with certification) — nurses who move into bookkeeping tend to be excellent because they already have the "chart everything" instinct
>
> **Legal assistant / paralegal** — documentation under scrutiny is home turf
>
> **Audit / compliance support** for regulated industries (food service, elder care, childcare)
>
> **Research assistant** for academics, journalists, nonfiction writers

Earnings reality: Bookkeeping $25–75/hour; a solo practice of 8–12 small-business clients runs $3–8K/month. Paralegals $22–42/hour in Louisiana. Compliance consulting $60–125/hour in regulated niches.

07 Working inside regulatory boundaries

Navigating rules, scope, and liability without breaking them.

You already know how to operate inside a rulebook — scope of practice, HIPAA, charting standards, reporting obligations. That ability to **work carefully inside constraints without freezing up** is unusual. Plenty of smart people either ignore rules (and get in trouble) or refuse to start anything because rules exist (and never build). You know how to do the thing and stay inside the lines.

> WHERE THIS SKILL PAYS OUTSIDE HEALTHCARE
>
> **Privacy compliance consulting** (HIPAA, GDPR, state privacy laws) — any business with customer data needs this and most don't have it
>
> **Insurance support / benefits navigation** — helping families navigate Medicare, Medicaid, private insurance appeals
>
> **Licensed home childcare or adult daycare operator** — Louisiana regulations are specific, and operators who understand them run profitable businesses
>
> **Grant writing for social-service nonprofits** — the job is understanding rules and writing inside them

Earnings reality: Privacy consulting $75–200/hour. Insurance appeals support $50–125 per case. Grant writers $25–85/hour or 5–10% commission on funded grants. Home childcare ~$40–80K/year as owner-operator depending on licensed capacity.

How to think about which one fits

Don't pick by prestige or pay rate. Pick by **which one makes you lean in when you read it.** That lean-in is not sentiment — it's recognition. Your nervous system knows what it wants to practice.

Then test cheaply. Every pattern above can be tested in 2–4 weeks without quitting your day job, without spending more than a few hundred dollars, and without committing to anything:

- Read two books and one trade publication in the space
- Find three people already doing it and message them on LinkedIn — *"I'm exploring a move into X. Could I ask you three questions?"* Most will say yes.
- Try the work for one client at a reduced rate — friends-and-family, or via a platform like Upwork or Fiverr — just to feel whether you actually enjoy it

- Pay attention to energy, not outcome. If it drains you even when it goes well, it's not the path. If it energizes you even when it's clumsy, keep going.

> **WHAT THIS UNLOCKS**
>
> The honest truth: Scrubs & Scripture as a standalone faith-content blog has a slow revenue ceiling. But Scrubs & Scripture as a *platform run by an LPN who also operates a profitable [bookkeeping / ops consulting / grief-support / course-creation] business* is a completely different thing. The blog becomes the *credibility layer* — it shows you're a thoughtful, literate person with something to say — while the other business earns the living. That's how most six-figure solo operators in adjacent spaces actually work. Your nursing training is raw material for two or three careers, not one.

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§ 6

Hobby *or* Business?

Once you've decided to run the blog as a business, the IRS gets to weigh in on whether they agree. Getting this wrong is what causes deductions to be clawed back years later.

Under IRC §183 — the "hobby loss" rule — the IRS draws a hard line between two kinds of activity:

- **A business** can deduct ordinary and necessary expenses, including at a loss, against other income.
- **A hobby** cannot. Expenses are lost. Income is still taxed.

A blog started *primarily to generate write-offs* — with no genuine intent to earn a profit — is a hobby in the eyes of the IRS. And if it's audited and reclassified years later, the deductions get reversed, with penalties and interest.

> **THE FLIP IN FRAMING**
>
> The goal cannot be "start a blog to get write-offs." The goal has to be "start a blog as a genuine revenue-seeking business." The write-offs are a *byproduct* of running it like a real business — not the reason for starting it. Same actions, completely different IRS treatment.

The nine factors the IRS looks at

If the IRS ever questions the blog, these are the signals that tip the scale toward "business":

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS FOR SCRUBS & SCRIPTURE
Businesslike manner	Separate bank account, bookkeeping, receipts kept, a written plan.
Expertise	Your nursing background is a real, documented credential in the content area.
Time and effort	Consistent posting schedule, tracked hours, active site maintenance.
Expectation of profit	Monetization plan exists (affiliate, products, ads, services) — even if revenue is small at first.
Past success	Not required, but starting one helps.
History of income/loss	Profit in at least **3 of 5 years** can create a safe-harbor presumption of business under IRC §183 — the presumption is generally rebuttable, so records still matter.
Amount of profit earned	Revenue growth trajectory — even modest — matters more than the size.
Financial status	If the blog loses money while you have a high-paying day job, the IRS looks harder. Not disqualifying, just worth knowing.
Personal pleasure	A blog you enjoy writing can still be a business. The IRS knows that. Pleasure alone doesn't make it a hobby.

PRACTICAL TRANSLATION

In the first 12 months, the most important things you can do to establish "business intent" are: (1) open a separate business bank account, (2) keep every receipt, (3) post consistently, (4) add one monetization element (even a free email list is a start), and (5) document the plan. That's it. Those five things answer most of the nine factors.

§ 7

Sole Prop *or* LLC?

Two common paths. For a content blog with no physical product liability, the decision is simpler than for most businesses — but still has real consequences.

FACTOR	SOLE PROPRIETOR + DBA	SINGLE-MEMBER LLC
Setup cost	~$50–75 DBA + $0 EIN	$100 filing + $35 annual report
Liability shield	None — personal assets at risk	Yes — separates business from personal
Paperwork	Minimal. Schedule C at tax time.	Annual report, separate accounting, Operating Agreement.
Tax treatment	Pass-through. Schedule C.	Pass-through by default. Same as sole prop for taxes unless S-corp elected.
Write-off rules	Identical to LLC	Identical to sole prop
Best for	First 12 months, testing the model, low risk of liability claim	Once you're selling physical products, doing paid affiliate partnerships, or earning regular recurring revenue — your CPA will help pinpoint the right threshold for your situation

THE HONEST RECOMMENDATION — TO DISCUSS WITH A CPA

For a *purely devotional* blog with no products and no clinical advice, a sole proprietorship with a DBA ("Scrubs & Scripture") is often the practical starting point — low cost, low paperwork, similar tax treatment. It's worth revisiting the LLC decision once revenue becomes regular and meaningful, or the moment products, affiliate partnerships, or in-person services enter the picture. The liability conversation changes fast when money and health content mix. A CPA or small-business attorney can help you pinpoint the right moment for your situation.

Where to file in Louisiana

IF GOING SOLE PROP + DBA

St. Tammany Parish Clerk of Court — files the trade name ("Scrubs & Scripture") under your legal name.

701 N. Columbia St., Covington · (985) 809-8700

Louisiana SOS Business Search — check name availability first (free).

IF GOING LLC

geauxBIZ portal — file LLC Articles of Organization online.

$100 filing fee. 3–5 business days. Creates "Scrubs & Scripture LLC."

§ 8

The Covington *Setup Checklist*

Every box that needs checking to operate legitimately from a home address in the City of Covington. This is the part most online guides get wrong for this specific city.

COVINGTON IS DIFFERENT FROM MOST LOUISIANA CITIES

Unlike many parishes, **Covington requires an Occupational License for home-based businesses** — per Chapter 22 of the City Code and Louisiana Revised Statute § 47:341, as reflected in publicly available city sources as of April 2026. This is separate from a DBA, LLC, or state sales tax. Skipping it is a common compliance mistake for home-based bloggers in Covington. Municipal ordinances can change, so **confirm current requirements directly with the City of Covington Occupational License Department** at 317 N. Jefferson Avenue. Ellen Agee, Occupational License Administrator, **(985) 867-1214 ext. 241** · eagee@covla.com.

The required filings, in order

1. FEDERAL EIN (FREE, INSTANT)

Apply for EIN at IRS.gov

Free. Instant. Required for LLC and for opening a business bank account. Apply Mon–Fri, 7am–10pm ET.

2. DBA OR LLC FILING (CHOOSE ONE)

geauxBIZ (LLC) — if forming the LLC

St. Tammany Parish Clerk of Court (DBA) — if staying sole prop

701 N. Columbia St., Covington · (985) 809-8700

3. CITY OF COVINGTON OCCUPATIONAL LICENSE (REQUIRED)

Occupational License Department — City of Covington

Contact Ellen Agee: (985) 867-1214 ext. 241 · eagee@covla.com | Or Bridget Cohea: ext. 240 · bcohea@covla.com

Home Occupation requirements (PDF)

Lists exact forms: Zoning Verification, Avenu Insights Occupational License Application, Building Compliance Form

Covington "Opening a Business" page

Office location: 317 N. Jefferson Ave., Covington

4. LOUISIANA STATE SALES TAX — LATAP (ONLY IF SELLING PRODUCTS/SERVICES)

LaTAP — Louisiana Taxpayer Access Point

Free. ~30 minutes. Only required if you start selling digital products, physical goods, or taxable services. **Not** required for ad revenue, affiliate income, or sponsored posts alone.

5. ST. TAMMANY PARISH SALES TAX (ONLY IF REQUIRED ABOVE)

St. Tammany Parish Sheriff — Sales Tax Division

The Sheriff's Office is the single tax collector for all municipalities in the parish. Combined Covington sales tax rate: **9.25%** (5% state + 4.25% local).

Parish E-File

Monthly filing system. Due the 20th of each month.

6. BUSINESS BANK ACCOUNT (CRITICAL FOR IRS "BUSINESSLIKE MANNER")

Open at any bank or credit union (Hancock Whitney, Home Bank, Keesler FCU are all Louisiana-friendly). Bring EIN letter, DBA certificate or LLC Articles, and driver's license.

This single step is the most important thing you can do for your hobby-vs-business defense. Do not use a personal account for blog income/expenses.

Printable checklist

- [ ] Verify "Scrubs & Scripture" DBA availability on LA SOS search
- [ ] File DBA with St. Tammany Clerk of Court OR file LLC via geauxBIZ
- [ ] Apply for EIN at IRS.gov (same day)
- [ ] Complete Covington Zoning Verification Form
- [ ] Submit Occupational License Application to City of Covington (317 N. Jefferson)
- [ ] Open business bank account (bring EIN + DBA/LLC papers)
- [ ] Set up bookkeeping system (Wave is free; QuickBooks Self-Employed ~$15/mo)
- [ ] Save all paperwork digitally (Google Drive folder: "Scrubs & Scripture / Legal")
- [ ] *If selling products later:* Register on LaTAP for state sales tax
- [ ] *If selling products later:* Register with St. Tammany Parish Sales Tax Division

§ 9

Week-by-Week *Launch Schedule*

A realistic timeline for getting fully set up from nothing to legitimate in about three weeks of calendar time and roughly four hours of actual effort.

01 WEEK 1 — IDENTITY

Decide structure (sole prop vs. LLC). File DBA with St. Tammany Clerk *or* file LLC on geauxBIZ. Apply for EIN on irs.gov the same day. Call Covington Occupational License office to confirm exactly which forms your address needs.

Outcome: Legal identity, EIN in hand, zoning clarity.

02 WEEK 2 — CITY

Submit Occupational License application at 317 N. Jefferson Ave. (in person is fastest). Complete Zoning Verification Form. Open business bank account. Set up free Wave bookkeeping or QuickBooks Self-Employed.

Outcome: City-compliant. Bank account live. Bookkeeping running.

03 WEEK 3 — CONTENT & PROTECTION

Add the disclaimer language (§7 of this guide) to the blog footer and About page. Start email list (Kit/ConvertKit has a free tier). Buy domain-based email (wanda@scrubsscripture.com via Google Workspace — ~$7/mo, deductible).

Outcome: Public-facing legal protections in place.

04 WEEK 4 AND BEYOND — RHYTHM

Weekly posting rhythm. Monthly bookkeeping review (30 minutes). Quarterly review of income vs. expenses. Year-end CPA appointment booked in November.

Outcome: Ongoing compliance rhythm that defends the business classification.

IF THIS FEELS LIKE A LOT

It *is* a lot. And it doesn't have to land on your shoulders alone.

Forms. Phone numbers. Deadlines. Agency acronyms that sound like alphabet soup. The good news: none of it is hard once someone who's done it before is in the room with you. The hard part is the doing-it-alone.

- → Sit with you while you make the sole-prop vs. LLC decision in plain language
- → Walk the Covington, St. Tammany, and state filings through with you — step by step
- → Get the disclaimers, policies, and legal guardrails onto your site correctly the first time
- → Set up the bookkeeping and email list so tax time isn't a scramble in December

Think of it less as hiring a service and more as having a neighbor who happens to know this terrain. We keep things simple, we don't upsell, and we work at a pace that fits your life.

LET'S TALK

— **BayouBuilt Digital**, *a service of D&G Fuzion LLC*

§ 10

What's Actually *a Write-Off?*

The rule from IRS Publication 535: an expense must be both "ordinary" (common for the industry) and "necessary" (helpful and appropriate) for the business.

HOW TO READ THIS SECTION

Everything below is a *general educational overview* of which expense categories are commonly deductible for content-based small businesses. Whether any specific expense is deductible for your situation depends on documentation, business-use percentage, and IRS rules that change year to year. Use this as a vocabulary for conversations with your CPA — not as a substitute for one. A 30-minute paid consultation with a CPA once you have receipts to point at will do more than any checklist.

Categories commonly deductible for content businesses

CATEGORY	EXAMPLES	GENERAL NOTES
Website & hosting	Wix plan, domain renewal, SSL, stock photos, site icons	Generally fully deductible when exclusively for the business
Software	Canva Pro, Grammarly, ConvertKit, Google Workspace, QuickBooks	Generally fully deductible for business-exclusive tools
Equipment (prorated)	Laptop, ring light, microphone, tripod, external drive	Business-use percentage applies (e.g., 70% if also personal)
Home office	Portion of rent/mortgage interest, utilities, internet	See IRS Pub 587. Must be a dedicated space used regularly and exclusively.
Mileage	Driving to conferences, interviews, photo shoots for the blog	IRS sets the standard mileage rate annually; check irs.gov for the current year. Log it in MileIQ or similar.

CATEGORY	EXAMPLES	GENERAL NOTES
Education	Blogging courses, books on writing, faith-writing conferences	Generally deductible when tied to the business
Professional services	CPA fees, attorney review, business coach	Generally deductible
Marketing	Facebook ads, business cards, email marketing tool	Generally deductible
Photography	Stock photos, headshot session, props for photos	Generally deductible when used for the blog
Subscriptions	Industry publications, Adobe, research tools	Generally deductible when business-related

Categories that are *generally not* deductible (common mistakes)

- **Scrubs and work clothes** — even though the blog is literally named "Scrubs & Scripture," work uniforms are generally *not* deductible if they can be worn outside work. And your scrubs are for your LPN job, not the blog.
- **Your personal Bible** — personal use. A separate devotional or research library purchased for content creation *could* be, if clearly used for the blog.
- **Tithes and church donations** — these are generally treated as personal charitable giving (Schedule A), not business expenses.
- **Coffee at a coffee shop while you write** — generally not deductible unless it's a documented business meeting with a specific person.
- **Family vacation where you "also took photos"** — this is a classic audit trigger. Don't do it.
- **The full cost of your phone / internet / laptop** — only the business-use percentage, in most cases.

THE HOME OFFICE DEDUCTION — HANDLE WITH CARE

This is one of the most scrutinized deductions in the tax code. The IRS's rules (Pub 587): the space must be used *regularly* AND *exclusively* for the business. The kitchen table doesn't count. A dedicated desk in a corner of a room, used only for blog work, generally does. Measure the square footage honestly, take a photo of the setup, and keep it in the records. Because this deduction is high-risk, walking it through with a CPA in year one is strongly worth the cost.

§ 11

The LPN *License Question*

Your LPN license is your most valuable professional asset. Everything in this section exists to protect it.

Louisiana has a quirk most national guides miss: LPNs and RNs have **separate regulatory boards**. LPNs are governed by the Louisiana State Board of Practical Nurse Examiners (LSBPNE), not the Board of Nursing (LSBN). Any scope-of-practice question has to go to LSBPNE — not LSBN, not a generic "ask a nurse" forum.

What LSBPNE says about LPN scope

Per the Scope of Practice page: LPNs perform nursing acts *under the direction of* a licensed physician, optometrist, dentist, or RN. LPNs cannot independently make patient assessments or develop nursing diagnoses.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BLOG

Any time you tell a reader what to do about a medical condition — even implicitly — you are potentially "practicing nursing" in a way that requires a physician's direction you don't have. The fix is not to stop writing about healthcare topics. The fix is to write about them *in a voice that is clearly reflection, encouragement, and personal testimony* — not clinical direction. §7 walks through exactly how.

Three things that will always protect your license

These are widely accepted guardrails — but the definitive source is LSBPNE. If you're unsure whether something crosses the line, call them first (see §19 for the phone number).

1. **Never diagnose.** Avoid suggesting what a reader "probably has" or "likely is."
2. **Never prescribe or dose.** No specific medications, supplements at specific doses, or treatment protocols.
3. **Never violate HIPAA.** Zero stories involving identifiable patients, even if names are changed — identifying details (unit, hospital, timeframe) can be enough to violate. See HHS HIPAA guidance.

What about your employer?

Most healthcare employers have social media and moonlighting policies in their employment contracts. Before you promote the blog or mention your employer anywhere, you should:

- Pull your employee handbook and read the social media policy.
- Confirm whether the employer requires written approval for outside income.
- Never identify your employer by name on the blog (or in any post's metadata).
- Never post in uniform with employer logos visible.

PART TWO

The Content *Playbook*

How to write, what to write, what not to write, and how to turn it into sustainable income without compromising the mission or the license.

§ 12

Prescriptive *vs.* Educational Language

This is the hinge between "writing about healthcare as an LPN with your license intact" and "writing about healthcare in a way that could invite a complaint to LSBPNE." The difference is voice, not topic.

The rule: **share experiences, observations, and encouragement — do not give instructions.** Below are side-by-side examples of sentences to avoid and sentences that convey the same idea safely.

Example 1 — Stress and burnout

✗ AVOID

"If you're feeling burned out, you should take magnesium glycinate before bed — 400mg is the sweet spot. It'll help with your sleep and anxiety."

This prescribes a specific supplement and dose. Crosses into advice requiring clinical judgment.

✓ INSTEAD

"After a hard shift, I've leaned on a few small habits that have helped me rest — quiet, a warm shower, and my nightly Psalm. If you're struggling with sleep, your own doctor is the right person to help you figure out what your body needs."

Personal testimony + redirect to appropriate professional. Completely safe.

Example 2 — Grief on the job

✗ AVOID

"If you've lost a patient and can't stop crying at work, you probably have acute stress reaction. You need to see a therapist within two weeks or it'll turn into PTSD."

Diagnoses a condition, prescribes a timeline, predicts a clinical outcome.

✓ INSTEAD

"Losing a patient stays with you. I've sat in the parking lot and cried more times than I can count. Here's what Scripture taught me about grief that helps on those days — and why reaching out for real support, whether that's a therapist or a pastor or a trusted friend, isn't weakness."

Testimony + reflection + encouragement toward qualified help. Your voice shines through.

Example 3 — A reader writes in about their own symptoms

✗ AVOID

"You said you've had chest pain and shortness of breath for three days. That sounds like it could be a panic attack, but it could also be cardiac. Try deep breathing first, and if that doesn't help, go to the ER."

Evaluates symptoms, weighs differentials, advises on urgency. This is nursing practice without direction.

✓ INSTEAD

"Friend, I'm so glad you reached out — but what you're describing needs a real professional looking at you, not a blog comment. Please call your doctor today, or if it feels urgent, don't wait. I'll be praying for you."

Refuses to diagnose, redirects appropriately, stays pastoral. This is the model response for every symptom question.

Example 4 — Affirmations and mental health

✗ AVOID

"Daily affirmations will cure your depression. Forget the meds — here are 10 Bible verses that replace therapy."

Discourages medical treatment — a serious harm, and a near-certain complaint-trigger for a licensed nurse.

✓ INSTEAD

"Scripture has been a steady anchor for me during dark seasons — and so has therapy, and so have medications when I've needed them. Faith and clinical care aren't rivals. Here are five verses I return to when the weight gets heavy."

Holds faith and clinical reality together. This is the voice your audience is looking for.

The three-word test

Before hitting publish, run every post through three words:

THE TEST

Am I *sharing*, *telling*, or *teaching clinically*? If it's sharing (testimony, reflection, Scripture), publish. If it's telling (gentle encouragement, redirection to a real professional), publish. If it's teaching clinically (diagnosing, prescribing, advising on treatment) — rewrite it first.

§ 13

Finding *Your Voice*

The single most valuable thing your blog can have is a voice that sounds unmistakably like you. The good news: everyone starts without one. The better news: it shows up through consistent practice — not through perfect drafting.

Where you are right now — honestly

The first three posts on Scrubs & Scripture read as AI-assisted — warm and competent, but in a register that could have been written by almost any faith-content generator. That's not a criticism. Almost every blog in its first month has the same issue. AI tools are built to produce exactly that kind of clean, inoffensive, *anonymous* prose. They're good at first drafts and terrible at voice.

Here's what matters: readers can usually tell. Not always consciously, but they can tell. AI-generated content has distinct tells — predictable rhythm, softened opinions, tidy three-part structures, a kind of reassuring smoothness that feels like nothing because it sounds like everything. Over time, a reader's attention drifts away from content that sounds like it could have come from anywhere.

The opposite of that is what you're after: writing that feels like a specific person said it. Not polished, not professional — *recognizable.* That's what builds a readership that stays.

> **THE REFRAME**
>
> This section isn't about "protecting a voice you already have." It's about *finding one.* The voice is already inside you — in how you talk about hard shifts with a friend over coffee, in the specific way you comfort a scared patient, in the phrases you reach for when something moves you. The work is getting those onto the page.

What AI-generated content sounds like

Before you can recognize your own voice, it helps to recognize the one you're trying to move away from. Here are the signatures of AI-assisted writing:

✗ COMMON AI PATTERNS TO WATCH FOR

"In today's fast-paced healthcare environment..."
"It's important to remember that..."
"In this blog post, we'll explore..."
"By incorporating these practices into your daily routine..."
"Remember, you're not alone in this journey."

Each phrase is grammatically fine. None are *wrong.* They're just interchangeable — the kind of sentences that could open ten thousand different blogs and fit them all equally. That's the opposite of voice.

What your voice might sound like (once you find it)

Your voice will reveal itself through specifics. Specific moments. Specific phrases you use when you're not trying to sound writerly. Specific opinions you actually hold. A couple of hypotheticals — not as templates, but as flavor:

✓ SIGNS A SENTENCE SOUNDS LIKE A PERSON

"The chapel at the hospital smells like industrial carpet and lilies, and I sat in the back row for forty minutes last Tuesday trying to figure out what I believed anymore."

"My grandmother used to say nursing was a calling. I think she was romanticizing a job she never had to do."

"Here's the thing nobody told me about night shift: you stop being afraid of the dark and start being afraid of the silence."

Notice what's in there: specific places, specific times, confessional honesty, an opinion with an edge. Those aren't literary tricks — they're just *what you actually think and remember,* written down without first being sanded smooth. That's the direction to move.

How to find your voice — a practice, not a formula

1. **Write one post a week without AI, ever.** Even a short one. 400 words. No chatbot, no editor, no smoothing. Just you at a keyboard after a shift. Most of these won't be great — that's the point. You're not publishing practice, you're building a muscle. Save them in a private doc.

2. **Read your old text messages and voice memos.** That's where your real voice lives — when you're not trying to sound like anything. If you text a friend about a hard day, the way you phrase it is closer to your voice than any blog post you've ever polished.
3. **Write about small, specific moments.** Not "navigating the challenges of healthcare." One patient. One hallway conversation. One 2 AM thought. Specificity is the fastest route to voice. Generality is what AI produces by default.
4. **Keep a "found voice" file.** When you write or say something that sounds distinctly like you — a phrase, a sentence, a way of framing something — write it down. Over a few months, patterns emerge. Those patterns are the beginning of your voice.
5. **Read writers whose voices you admire.** Not to copy them — to calibrate your ear. Anne Lamott, Kate Bowler, Tish Harrison Warren, Lauren Winner all write in the faith-memoir space with distinct voices. Read a chapter of any of them and see how quickly you can hear them on the page.

How to use AI without it flattening you

You don't have to quit using AI. It's useful for research, outlines, and breaking writer's block. The rule is simple: **AI can help you think, but it should never do the final writing.** If a sentence makes it to published without passing through your voice, it doesn't belong there.

Here are prompts designed to keep AI in its lane — helping without replacing.

PROMPT 1 — GET UNSTUCK WITHOUT GETTING WRITTEN-FOR

THINKING PARTNER

```
I'm working on a blog post about [topic]. I don't want you to draft it. I want
you to ask me 5 questions that would help me figure out what I actually want to
say — the kind of questions a thoughtful editor would ask before I start
writing. Do not suggest answers. Just ask the questions.
```

PROMPT 2 — OUTLINE SCAFFOLDING (YOU WRITE THE PROSE)

STRUCTURE ONLY

Please generate an outline only — — for a blog post on *[topic]*.

Format:
- 4–6 bullet points maximum
- Each bullet should be a fragment, not a full idea
- Suggest one small specific moment or anecdote I could anchor the post around

I will write the actual post in my own words.

PROMPT 3 — PRESSURE-TEST A DRAFT YOU ALREADY WROTE

VOICE AUDIT

Here is a post I wrote myself:

[paste your draft]

Please analyze it for authenticity. Specifically:
1. Identify any sentence that sounds like it could have been generated by an AI
2. Point to the sentence that sounds *most* like a real person wrote it
3. Suggest , not what to add

Do not rewrite anything. Just mark it up.

PROMPT 4 — RESEARCH WITHOUT OUTSOURCING YOUR THINKING

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

I'm writing about *[topic]*. Please give me:
1. Three credible sources I should read before writing
2. Two perspectives on this topic I should make sure I've considered
3. One common misconception I should avoid repeating

Do not give me a summary of the topic itself. I want to do my own thinking.

THE MENTAL MODEL

Think of AI the way a thoughtful writer thinks of a research assistant or an editor. Useful for questions, structure, fact-checking, and catching weak spots — but the actual writing is *your* job. Every sentence that goes out under your name should have been touched by your mind and your voice. That's not a high bar. It's the *only* bar.

A WARNING SIGN TO WATCH FOR

If you're about to publish a post and catch yourself thinking *"I don't totally recognize this as mine, but it sounds professional enough"* — stop. That feeling is the signal. Professional-sounding isn't the goal. **Recognizably yours** is. A reader who can tell within two sentences that a post was written by you, specifically — that's what every piece of writing is aiming at.

The long game

Your voice isn't something you'll discover in a week. It shows up gradually — usually after 20 or 30 honest posts, almost always in the moments when you stopped trying to sound like a blogger and just wrote what you actually thought. Three years from now your writing will be better than today's writing — not because AI helped, but because you kept showing up and paying attention to your own sentences.

The goal isn't any perfect post. The goal is a body of work — a hundred posts down the road — where a reader can open any one of them and know, within two paragraphs, that it came from you and nobody else. That's the asset. Every week of genuine writing is a deposit toward it.

A CLOSER LOOK — SCRUBS & SCRIPTURE, TODAY

The site is a good *start.* Here's what a careful eye sees.

We pulled scrubsscripture.com up on a phone this week and walked through it the way a first-time reader would. Here's the honest list — not to overwhelm, but to show you what professional review looks like. Most of these are 10-minute fixes. A few reshape how a visitor feels in the first three seconds.

PRIORITY 1 — MOBILE RENDERING

→ **Hero title cuts off on mobile.** On a phone, "Scrubs & Scripture" reads as "Scrubs & Scriptu" with "re" broken onto its own line. Desktop font size is being used on mobile — needs a separate mobile-specific size around 56–64pt.

→ **Hero image fills the entire first screen.** First-time visitors see only a cross and the title before they scroll. The tagline and any call-to-action are below the fold — a significant portion of readers never see them. Hero height should be reduced on mobile.

→ **Gold-on-sunlight contrast breaks where the flare is brightest.** A soft 15–25% dark gradient overlay behind the title would fix readability without dimming the image.

PRIORITY 2 — VOICE & BRAND

→ **The tagline is elegant but not memorable. "Bridging Compassionate Care with Eternal Truth"**

→ **The About paragraph reads as AI-generated. "My journey in healthcare began with a calling to**

→ **Small copy snag: "Meet the heart behind the scrub" should read "scrubs" to match the brand**

→ **Newsletter signup copy is generic. "Receive weekly reflections bridging clinical care with spi**

PRIORITY 3 — MISSING ESSENTIALS

→ **No visible medical disclaimer.** Given the LPN license, the disclaimer blocks from §14 of this guide need to live on every page — footer at minimum. This is protection, not paperwork.

→ **Social icons link to generic homepages.** The Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, X, LinkedIn, and TikTok icons in the footer all point to the platform homepages (placeholder links). Broken-looking links tank credibility. Either connect real accounts or remove the icons until ready.

→ **No clear single call-to-action on the hero.** "Read Latest" and "About the Mission" are quiet commands. A specific invitation ("Read the latest post — [post title]") performs better than a generic one.

PRIORITY 4 — STRUCTURE & DEPTH

→ **Only three posts published.** Before any marketing push, aim for 8–10 posts — a reader who finds you via search will bounce if the archive feels empty. A weekend of honest, un-AI'd writing (see §12) gets you there.

→ **The numbered 01–06 image grid lacks context.** Currently unlabeled — readers don't know if these are posts, photos, chapters, or something else. Adding a simple heading like "Recent Reflections" or "Latest Posts" would clarify instantly.

→ **No "Start Here" entry point.** First-time visitors don't know what to read first. One pinned post or an About page that doubles as an entry point gives a clear way in.

→ **Wix template patterns are visible.** The default gallery hover state and standard strip layouts read as "this is a Wix template." Custom image treatment (unified tone, consistent overlay, or bespoke hover state) lifts the site from template-feel to chosen-on-purpose.

THIS IS WHAT WE DO

BayouBuilt Digital catches *all of this* — so you don't have to.

Most small-business owners don't know what they don't know about their own site. It's not your job to know — it's ours. Every client engagement starts with an audit like the one above: a careful walk-through on real devices, flagging what actually matters and in what order. Then we fix it, together or on your behalf, at whatever pace makes sense.

Site audits

A careful review of what's working, what's quietly hurting you, and what to fix first — in plain language.

Mobile & design polish

Fixing the things your visitors notice but you won't see from your desktop. Typography, spacing, contrast, flow.

Copy that sounds like you

About pages, taglines, email signup copy, and site voice — written with you, in your voice, not AI's.

Steady guidance

Ongoing partnership as your blog grows — so you're never stuck on the next decision alone.

Whether you want a one-time audit and fix sprint, a slow hand over a few months, or a full rebuild when the blog grows — we meet you where you are. No packages you don't need. No long contracts. Just the right work, done well, at a pace that fits your life.

SCHEDULE A FREE SITE WALKTHROUGH

— **BayouBuilt Digital**, *a service of D&G Fuzion LLC*

§ 14

Required *Disclaimer Language*

Three blocks of copy that need to live on the site. Together they establish: (1) this is not medical advice, (2) the reader has not formed a nurse-patient relationship, and (3) any affiliate income is disclosed per FTC rules.

Block 1 — Footer disclaimer (every page)

Scrubs & Scripture is a personal ministry blog by Wanda Pizzolato, LPN. Content on this site reflects personal reflection, faith, and experience — it is not medical, nursing, or mental health advice, and reading this site does not create a nurse-patient relationship. For any medical concern, please consult your own licensed healthcare provider. For spiritual care, please seek guidance from a trusted pastor or counselor. © 2026 Scrubs & Scripture. All rights reserved.

Block 2 — About / full disclaimer page

About this site

Scrubs & Scripture is written by Wanda Pizzolato, a Licensed Practical Nurse in Louisiana. All content represents personal reflection and encouragement rooted in faith and in her own journey through healthcare work. Nothing on this site is intended as — or should be interpreted as — medical advice, nursing advice, diagnosis, treatment recommendations, or a substitute for care from a qualified healthcare professional.

Reading this blog does not create a professional relationship of any kind. If you are experiencing a medical or mental health concern, please contact your own physician, nurse practitioner, therapist, or in an emergency dial 911 or go to your nearest emergency room. If you are in crisis, the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline is available 24/7.

Scripture quotations are from [versions used]. Views expressed are personal and do not represent the views of any employer, healthcare facility, or denomination.

Block 3 — Affiliate / sponsorship disclosure (when monetization starts)

Disclosure

Some links on Scrubs & Scripture are affiliate links, which means I may earn a small commission if you make a purchase through them — at no extra cost to you. I only recommend products I genuinely use or believe in. Sponsored content is always labeled. This complies with the FTC Endorsement Guides.

DO NOT SKIP THIS

The FTC has been active in enforcing disclosure requirements for bloggers and influencers. Even a free product received for review must be disclosed. Add the label **#ad** or **#sponsored** clearly — not buried in hashtags.

§ 15

The 90-Day *Content Plan*

A rhythm designed to (a) grow the audience, (b) establish authority without stepping outside LPN scope, and (c) build the asset library that every monetization path will need.

Weekly rhythm

DAY	ACTIVITY	TIME
Monday	Publish one 600–900 word blog post	90 min
Tuesday	Email list reflection — short (150–250 words) + one verse	20 min
Wednesday	Instagram/Facebook post: one graphic, one verse, link to latest post	15 min
Thursday	Reply to comments & emails. Engage in 3 other healthcare/faith communities.	30 min

DAY	ACTIVITY	TIME
Friday	Short testimony post / story (Instagram Reels or blog "Friday Reflection")	30 min
Weekend	Rest (the point of the whole brand). Batch next week's graphics.	60 min

Four pillar content themes to rotate

1. **Scripture for the shift** — a verse + reflection tied to a specific shift moment (a hard admission, a code, a long night).
2. **Faith when it's heavy** — grief, burnout, moral injury in healthcare, from a reflective (not clinical) angle.
3. **The caregiver's soul care** — rest, prayer practices, Sabbath, identity beyond the job.
4. **Stories from the hallway** — generalized, HIPAA-safe narratives about humanity, compassion, and faith witnessed in healthcare.

First 12 post ideas (safe, on-brand, audience-building)

1. "What twelve-hour shifts taught me about Sabbath"
2. "The prayer I say before walking into a patient's room"
3. "On the days I couldn't feel God in the hospital"
4. "Scripture for night shift: five verses for 3 a.m."
5. "Why nurses burn out — and what I'm learning about rest"
6. "The hardest shift of my career, and the verse that carried me home"
7. "Faith and clinical reality: why they're not rivals"
8. "A letter to the new LPN who's questioning her calling"
9. "Grief is not a problem to solve" (on losing patients)
10. "What I pray on the way to work"
11. "Scripture, therapy, and medication: my honest story"
12. "Five books that shaped me as a nurse and a believer"

§ 16

Monetization *Paths*

Ranked by fit with your skills, legal risk given your LPN license, and income potential. Most successful faith + healthcare creators layer three or four of these together.

ABOUT THE TAX NOTES IN THIS SECTION

Each monetization path below includes a short note about the general tax category it typically falls into. These are *educational classifications* — not tax advice for your specific situation. Tax outcomes depend on your total income picture, your business structure, your state filings, your expense documentation, and factors only a licensed CPA can weigh together. Treat these notes as a starting vocabulary for the CPA conversation in §20 — not as a substitute for it.

1. Email list + digital devotionals

$ · LOWEST RISK

A weekly email reflection, then a $9 devotional PDF, then a $19 printable journal, then a $29 30-day study. This is the canonical faith-content ladder — low risk because the content stays in her lane (reflection + Scripture).

General tax category: Digital products sold directly may trigger Louisiana sales tax registration. Selling via Gumroad, Etsy, or Payhip typically uses marketplace facilitator rules — those platforms usually collect and remit sales tax — but thresholds and obligations change; confirm with your CPA before launch.

2. Affiliate income

$$ · LOW RISK

Books, Bibles, journals, planners, devotionals, faith-based tools. Amazon Associates (lowest commission but easiest), Christian Book Distributors, Faithful Counseling partnerships. Requires FTC disclosure on every post that contains a link.

General tax category: 1099 income generally reported on Schedule C. No sales tax typically required, since the retailer is making the sale.

3. Display ads

$$ · LOW RISK · NEEDS TRAFFIC

Once traffic exceeds ~50,000 monthly sessions, networks like Mediavine, Raptive, or Journey by Mediavine pay substantially. Below that threshold, Ezoic or Google AdSense work but pay much less. This is passive once set up.

General tax category: 1099 income, typically Schedule C. Sales tax generally not applicable.

4. Speaking & retreats

$$$ · MEDIUM RISK

Women's ministry events, nurse associations, faith-based healthcare conferences, church retreats. Low-volume, high-ticket — a single weekend retreat can net $2,000–5,000. Natural fit for your voice.

General tax category: Schedule C income. Mileage, travel, and lodging tied to events are generally deductible when business purpose is documented. May be worth revisiting the LLC question once speaking becomes regular, due to liability exposure at live events.

5. Sponsored content / brand partnerships

$$$ · MEDIUM RISK

Faith brands (She Reads Truth, Dayspring), nurse-focused brands (scrubs companies, shoes), Christian publishers. Typically $200–2,000 per post once audience exceeds ~5,000 engaged followers. Requires clear FTC disclosure.

General tax category: 1099 or direct payment, typically Schedule C. Products received at no cost may count as taxable income at fair market value — something to review with your CPA.

6. Community / membership

$$$ · MEDIUM RISK

A monthly Patreon, Substack paid tier, or private Circle community for nurses who want ongoing reflection, prayer support, and resources. Recurring revenue. Scales without scaling her time.

General tax category: Recurring 1099 income via the platform. Most platforms (Substack, Patreon, Circle) handle payment processing and send year-end tax forms — but verify reporting thresholds with your CPA.

7. Book deal

$$$$ · LONG GAME

The natural endpoint of a well-built faith + healthcare platform. Faith publishers (Zondervan, Bethany House, Revell, B&H) actively acquire from nurse-authors with audiences. Not quick, not easy — but real.

General tax category: Advance and royalties are generally self-employment income. Literary agent fees and book tour expenses tied to the business are typically deductible when properly documented — your CPA will confirm.

8. 1:1 coaching — "faith & career" for nurses

$$ · HIGHER RISK — SEE NOTE

Coaching *Christian nurses* through burnout, career decisions, or calling discernment is viable — but only if it's clearly framed as faith/life coaching, not clinical supervision or therapy. The line matters. A written services agreement spelling out what coaching is and isn't is essential.

General tax category: Typically Schedule C. Sales tax may apply to coaching services in Louisiana — confirm with your CPA. **Legal note:** Louisiana regulates counseling practice. If services drift into counseling territory, LLC + professional liability insurance are worth discussing with an attorney before launch.

A PATH TO AVOID (FOR NOW)

Selling supplements, essential oils, MLM products, or "nurse-endorsed" health products as an LPN in a state where LPNs practice under physician direction is a fast path to a complaint with LSBPNE. Even if a product is benign, the *appearance* of an LPN endorsing clinical products outside your practice invites scrutiny. If a brand pitches this, politely decline.

§ 17

Building *the Platform*

A profitable faith + healthcare platform sits on three legs: content that compounds, a list she owns, and a product ladder that meets readers where they are. Here's the order of operations.

Phase 1 — Months 1–3: Foundation

- Post weekly. Four pillar topics. Legal language rules followed without exception.
- Install the disclaimer on footer + About page.
- Start the email list today. Free tier of Kit (formerly ConvertKit) covers 10,000 subscribers.
- Offer a free opt-in: "10 Scriptures for the Hardest Shifts" (PDF).

Phase 2 — Months 4–6: Audience

- Instagram + Facebook page consistent posting. Reels work best for reach.
- Guest post on 3 faith blogs or nurse blogs to borrow audience.
- Launch first paid digital product: a $9 devotional PDF (30 days of nurse-focused devotionals).
- Add affiliate links (Amazon Associates + CBD) to relevant posts.

Phase 3 — Months 7–12: Income

- First speaking engagement (local nurse group or women's ministry).
- Apply to display ad network once traffic supports it.
- Consider the LLC conversation with a CPA.
- Second digital product: $19 printable journal or $29 study guide.
- Pitch first sponsor relationship with a faith brand.

Phase 4 — Year 2: Compounding

- Membership/community launch ($9–19/mo).
- Hybrid: in-person retreat + online companion course.
- Begin book proposal conversations with a literary agent.

- Full tax strategy review — possibly S-corp election once net income crosses ~$40K.

ONE LAST THING

Every big thing *starts as a small thing* with someone beside you.

The phases in this guide — foundation, audience, income, compounding — look like mountains when you read them in one sitting. They're not. They're small, repeatable weeks. A post. A filing. A reply to a reader. A page added to a journal. The mountain is just weeks, stacked.

What changes whether those weeks happen is almost always the same thing: whether there's someone in your corner who's seen the next step before. That's all we're offering.

- → A real website, built to reflect your voice — not a template
- → Help wiring up email, analytics, and the pieces that quietly compound
- → Check-ins when you hit a decision and don't want to decide alone
- → The kind of steady, unhurried support that makes year two actually arrive

When you're ready — whether that's next week or next year — we're here. No rush.

COME SAY HELLO

— **BayouBuilt Digital**, *a service of D&G Fuzion LLC*

§ 18

Grants Worth *Applying For*

An honest look at women-business grants — the ones you can apply to today, and the much bigger pool that opens up the moment you pivot from a blog to a real service business. Verified open as of April 2026.

READ THIS FIRST — THE GRANT LANDSCAPE, HONESTLY

Most women-business grants target businesses that have *revenue, employees, or at least a year of trading history.* Scrubs & Scripture right now is a three-post blog without monetization — that rules out most of the grant landscape at this exact moment. But here's the real news: **the moment you launch one of the service paths from §4** (caregiver navigation, new-LPN coaching, companion services, discharge support, or pill-organization visits) **and start earning revenue, a much larger grant universe opens up to you.** That's the difference between a blog and a business. Grants are built to fund *businesses*.

Applying to grants you have no realistic chance of winning is a time sink dressed up as productive work. This section sorts grants into three honest buckets: **apply right now**, **unlocks if you pivot to a real business**, and **worth revisiting at the 12-month mark**. Every grant below was verified as of April 2026.

Apply right now — no revenue required, low friction

These accept early-stage or pre-revenue applicants. Even with low win rates, the time cost is small enough to make them worth a Saturday morning.

1. Amber Grant (WomensNet)

APPLY NOW · MONTHLY

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE	TIME TO APPLY
$10,000/mo + $50K year-end	Monthly — rolling	$15	~30 minutes

Three $10,000 grants awarded every single month. Year-end, winners are eligible for an additional $25,000–50,000. No revenue minimum. No time-in-business requirement. Two-question application — no business plan, no pitch deck. One application enters you for all categories.

Why it fits: Best application-to-payoff ratio on the list. Your faith + healthcare niche gives you a real story to tell. Worth the $15 once — if you don't win this month, you're already in the queue.

Apply: ambergrantsforwomen.com

2. Galaxy Grant (Hidden Star)

APPLY NOW · 30 SECONDS · FREE

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE	TIME TO APPLY
$3,500	Quarterly — next Apr 30, 2026	Free	~30 seconds

Hidden Star is a 501(c)(3) that has supported women and minority entrepreneurs for nine years. Intentionally brief application — basic info about your business and how you'd use the funds. No essay. No pitch deck. No fee. Recent Louisiana winner: $2,450 to a New Orleans recipient in March 2025.

Why it fits: Free + 30 seconds + no eligibility barriers means the cost of applying is effectively zero. Set a quarterly reminder and apply every cycle.

Apply: galaxyofstars.org/galaxy-grants

3. IFundWomen Universal Application

APPLY NOW · MATCH ENGINE

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE	TIME TO APPLY
Varies by match	Rolling — one application	Free	~45 minutes

IFundWomen is a grant marketplace that partners with Visa, American Express, Neutrogena, Caress, and other corporate sponsors. You submit **one universal application** and IFundWomen matches your business against relevant opportunities as they open. Eliminates the need to re-apply for every individual grant. Also includes coaching and a founder community.

Why it fits: One-time investment, indefinite upside. Once you're in the system, you're automatically considered for future matches without lifting a finger. Some matches do require revenue — but many don't.

Apply: ifundwomen.com

Unlocks when you pivot to a real business

These grants require revenue, a service you actually sell, or some employment history — things a blog alone doesn't produce but a coaching practice, navigator service, or companion-care business does within a few months of launch. If you move forward on one of the §4 paths, these become genuinely winnable. Set a calendar reminder to revisit this list at the 6- and 12-month marks.

4. Louisiana LED Small & Emerging Business Development (SEBD)

PIVOT UNLOCK · LOUISIANA ONLY

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE	REQUIRES
$10,000–$200,000	Rolling applications	Free	Louisiana-based business

Louisiana Economic Development's flagship small-business grant. Funds equipment, working capital, training, building improvements. You must be headquartered in Louisiana (you are), majority-owned by Louisiana residents (you are), and applying for funds tied to job creation or growth. Grant amounts scale with projected job-creation impact — meaning a coaching business that eventually hires a VA scales better than a pure blog.

Why it unlocks with pivot: LED wants to see a *real business plan with projected job impact*. A service business (caregiver navigator, LPN coaching cohort, companion care) produces that plan naturally. A blog alone doesn't. The LSBDC advisor in Covington (see §19) will help you prepare the application for free.

Apply: opportunitylouisiana.gov/small-business · work through an LSBDC advisor first

5. Hey Helen Grant (Visionaries Collective)

PIVOT UNLOCK · REVENUE REQUIRED

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE
$10,000	3× per year — next Apr 30, 2026	$15 application

REQUIRES
100% women-owned, under $1M rev

Awarded three times per year to one woman or nonbinary business owner per cycle. Minimal paperwork but does require that your business is registered and generating some revenue. Founded by a networking platform focused on women business owners.

Why it unlocks with pivot: Requires a real, trading business — not a blog. Once you've sold one coaching package or one month of navigation service, you qualify. Small award pool means decent odds.

Apply: Search "Hey Helen Grant Visionaries Collective"

6. Intuit Small Business Hero Program

PIVOT UNLOCK · NOMINATION-BASED

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	FEE	REQUIRES
$20,000 + tools	Next cycle May 15, 2026	Free	1+ year operating, community impact

You can't submit yourself — a client, customer, mentor, or community member has to nominate you. Award includes $20,000 plus free QuickBooks Online Advanced and Mailchimp access for a year. Selection emphasizes *community impact* — specifically underrepresented communities served.

Why it unlocks with pivot: Requires one year of real operation plus community impact you can document (nurses helped, caregivers trained, patients navigated). Perfect fit for a faith-healthcare service business after year one. Start collecting testimonials and outcome stories from day one so the nomination is easy later.

Apply: intuit.com/impact/small-business-hero

7. Fund 17 / Kiva Microloans (New Orleans-based, serves Louisiana)

PIVOT UNLOCK · NOT A GRANT, BUT RELEVANT

AMOUNT	DEADLINE	INTEREST	REQUIRES
$1,000–$15,000	Rolling	0% (Kiva program)	Some business history

Fund 17 is a New Orleans nonprofit that partners with Kiva to provide **zero-interest loans** to micro-entrepreneurs across Louisiana, with focus on women, Black, Latino, immigrant, and veteran-owned businesses. Technically a loan not a grant — but the 0% interest makes it close enough to call out here. They also offer free coaching and an accelerator program.

Why it unlocks with pivot: They fund operational businesses, not blogs. Good path when you need a few thousand dollars of equipment or startup capital for a service launch.

Apply: fund17.org

Skip for now — here's why

These come up in every search but are either too competitive, too narrowly targeted, or require a stage you're nowhere near. Noted here so you know you can safely ignore them.

8. Cartier Women's Initiative

SKIP · REQUIRES $50K+ REVENUE

Global competition for women-led impact businesses generating between $50,000 and $5 million annually. Worth knowing exists; not winnable until you've built a real operation with meaningful revenue and demonstrable impact metrics. Revisit in year three if you go the platform route.

9. Tory Burch Foundation Fellows Program

SKIP · FELLOWSHIP, NOT CASH

Year-long fellowship with networking and mentorship, previously included a $5,000 cash component but that's been removed. Requires majority women-owned businesses with preference for $75K+ annual revenue. Useful eventually — not actionable now.

10. Verizon / Comcast RISE / large corporate grants

SKIP · APPLICATION LABOR TOO HIGH

These programs offer $5,000–$10,000 but require completing courses, submitting detailed applications, and are extremely competitive nationally. Return-on-effort is poor for a solo operator pre-launch. Put these on the 12-month revisit list.

THE STRATEGY THAT ACTUALLY WORKS

Spend **one hour this month** applying to the first three grants above (Amber, Galaxy, IFundWomen). Set a quarterly recurring reminder to reapply to Galaxy. Then stop thinking about grants and *focus on launching a service*. Once you have three paying clients and three months of revenue records, the Louisiana LED SEBD path becomes real — and that one, worked through a free LSBDC advisor, can fund $10K–$200K. The math is clear: 60 minutes on Amber + Galaxy + IFundWomen today, then grants return as a serious strategy the moment you've pivoted to an actual business. Not before.

A NOTE ON THE $19 AND $15 APPLICATION FEES

A few of the grants above charge small fees ($15–25 is common). That's a real cost you should weigh. The Amber Grant's $15 fee is *widely considered reasonable* given award size and legitimacy — it's how WomensNet funds judging operations. But some lesser-known programs charge fees and have vanishingly small win rates. Rule of thumb: **if the fee is more than 1% of the award amount or the win rate isn't publicly disclosed, skip it.** Free grants (Galaxy, IFundWomen, Louisiana SEBD, Fund 17) should always come first. Fee grants only if the award-to-fee ratio makes sense and the organization has a verifiable track record.

§ 19

Every Link *in One Place*

Bookmark this page. Every agency, every form, every resource referenced anywhere in this guide.

LOUISIANA STATE & ENTITY FORMATION

geauxBIZ — LLC formation & license checklist

LA SOS business name search

LaTAP — state sales tax

Parish E-File — combined state + parish filing

LOUISIANA LPN LICENSING (MOST IMPORTANT FOR YOU)

Louisiana State Board of Practical Nurse Examiners (LSBPNE)
Your board — not LSBN. Phone: (225) 755-7500.

LSBPNE Scope of Practice

LSBPNE Laws & Rules (Nurse Practice Act)

COVINGTON & ST. TAMMANY PARISH

City of Covington Occupational License Dept.
Ellen Agee: (985) 867-1214 ext. 241 · eagee@covla.com

Covington "Opening a Business"

Covington Home Occupation requirements (PDF)

St. Tammany Parish — Sales Tax Division

St. Tammany Parish Clerk of Court (DBA)

FEDERAL / IRS

EIN application (free, instant)

IRS — hobby vs. business guidance

IRS Publication 535 — business expenses

IRS Publication 587 — home office deduction

Schedule C (sole prop tax form)

FREE SMALL-BUSINESS ADVISORS NEAR YOU

Every one of these is free and local. A single one-hour session with any of them is more valuable than weeks of guessing on your own.

LSBDC at Southeastern Louisiana University

Your closest SBDC. Serves St. Tammany plus Livingston, St. Helena, Tangipahoa, and Washington parishes. Free, confidential one-on-one counseling with trained business advisors. Phone: **(985) 549-3831**. Main office in Hammond (~30 min from Covington).

St. Tammany EDC — LSBDC Satellite Office

Right in Covington. 1001 Hwy 190 East Service Rd, Suite 202. Since May 2025, LSBDC advisors hold sessions directly at the St. Tammany Economic Development Corporation office — you do not need to drive to Hammond. This is the easiest first stop. Request a consultation through louisianasbdc.org.

STartUP Northshore (SUNS)

St. Tammany EDC's program specifically for entrepreneurs. Coordinates with LSBDC. Good for connecting with other Northshore founders and accessing training events.

St. Tammany Chamber of Commerce

610 Hollycrest Blvd, Covington · **(985) 892-3216**. Partners with LSBDC for free business counseling through their programs. Ask for Connie Ernst (programs contact): **connie@sttammanychamber.org** · (985) 273-3006. Chamber membership is optional, but the counseling is available regardless — and the networking events are worth attending even as a visitor.

SCORE New Orleans

Free lifetime mentorship from retired and active business professionals. Covers the Greater New Orleans region including the Northshore. 1-on-1 mentor matching, free workshops, and an active library of templates. Request a mentor through score.org/neworleans/local-mentors.

Louisiana SBDC (statewide network)

The statewide hub. 10 regional centers across Louisiana. All services free. If for any reason the SLU center isn't responsive, you can also request counseling through Greater New Orleans region (hosted at Xavier University).

Louisiana Economic Development (LED)

State-level resources including small business certifications (LED SEBD for small/emerging businesses), Angel Investor Tax Credit, and industry-specific programs. Worth reviewing once you have an LLC or DBA in place.

> **A SPECIFIC FIRST-STEP RECOMMENDATION**
>
> If you only make one call in the next two weeks, make it to the **LSBDC satellite office at St. Tammany EDC** in Covington. Tell them you're an LPN exploring a small business and you'd like a free 1:1 counseling session. They will walk you through your specific situation — for free — with someone who has done this with hundreds of Northshore small business owners. Bring this guide with you. Ask specifically about: (1) whether your current plan matches what actually works in this market, (2) what local grants or certifications might apply (LED SEBD especially), and (3) whether an LLC makes sense for your current stage or whether sole prop is fine to start.

BLOGGER-SPECIFIC LEGAL & COMPLIANCE

HHS HIPAA for professionals

FTC Endorsement Guides

Nurses Service Organization — risk articles

TOOLS WORTH USING (MOST HAVE FREE TIERS)

Kit (ConvertKit) — email list

Wave — free bookkeeping

QuickBooks Self-Employed

Canva — graphics

MileIQ — mileage log

Gumroad — digital product sales

§ 20

Questions for *Your CPA*

A 30-minute paid consultation before the end of year one is cheap insurance. Bring this list.

1. Given my income from nursing plus a blog running at a loss the first year, what's my hobby-vs-business audit risk — and what records should I keep?
2. What's the right NAICS code for a faith/healthcare blog that may also sell digital products later?
3. At what revenue level does converting from sole prop to LLC make financial sense?
4. At what net income level should I consider an S-corp election?
5. What's the simplest bookkeeping system you recommend — Wave, QuickBooks Self-Employed, or spreadsheet?
6. How should I document the home office deduction to survive an audit?
7. What's the cleanest way to track my blog-vs-personal phone, internet, and laptop usage?
8. If I start earning affiliate or ad income, what quarterly estimated tax payments should I plan for?
9. Do you recommend a local commercial insurance broker for a blogger with a professional license?
10. Are there any Louisiana-specific deductions or credits I should be tracking from day one?

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Visit us any time at **bayoubuilt-digital.com** · Serving the Acadiana region and beyond.

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